

Getting Started with Moonlight Study

A gentle tour of your new local-first AI study companion

What is Moonlight Study?

Moonlight Study turns the documents you already own into a private, on-device study companion. Everything  reading, highlighting, note-taking, flashcard generation, and AI answers grounded in your material  runs locally on your machine. Nothing is uploaded, no account is required, and once your model is downloaded the app works completely offline.

-  Read PDFs with highlighting and sticky notes
-  Take bullet notes scoped to each document
-  Ask questions that are answered from your own documents (RAG)
-  Generate flashcards from what you study
-  Stay on pace with a cozy pomodoro timer
-  Play lofi or your own music while you work

Step 1: Import a document

Use the Import button (or drag a file onto the window) to add PDFs and images into a notebook. Moonlight Study copies the file into its own library folder, so you can move the original afterwards. Each notebook groups related documents.

Step 2: Choose a model

From the Models screen, pick a small, efficient model that fits your machine. The default Qwen2.5-VL-3B can read text AND images, which lets the app OCR scanned pages

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automatically. Models download once over the internet and then never need it again. Reasoning models (like DeepSeek-R1) show a collapsible "Thinking" block while they work through problems step by step.

Step 3: Interact with your material

Open a document in the reader. Use the tabs on the right to take notes or ask the assistant questions ☒ answers cite the sections of your document they came from. Highlight text to summarize, explain, or copy a selection instantly.

Study smarter

After a reading session, generate flashcards from the notes and text you've studied. Review them on the Flashcards screen. Plan focused sessions in the Planner and use the pomodoro timer to pace yourself ☒ each completed session is logged on your dashboard.

Privacy & tips

Everything stays on your device. Your library, notes, annotations, and settings live in your app data folder. If you ever need help, check Settings ☒ View logs to export troubleshooting information.

Happy studying ☒ good coffee, good lofi, good learning. ☒